Project Title:
Tourism Demand Under Shock: An Analysis of Political, Global, and Regional Crises on Turkey's Source Markets (2003–2025)

Proposal:
In this project, I aim to analyze how different types of shocks affect tourism demand in Turkey, focusing on how major source markets respond to political, global, and regional disruptions. The study will examine the impact of the Syrian civil war as an early regional border conflict, the 2016 attempted coup in Turkey as a domestic political shock, and the COVID-19 pandemic as a global shock. In addition, more recent geopolitical developments such as the Russia–Ukraine war and renewed tensions in the Middle East will be considered to evaluate differences in sensitivity and post-recovery dynamics across source markets.

The primary dataset consists of publicly available tourism statistics obtained from official sources such as **TÜİK (Turkish Statistical Institute)** and related border tourism datasets, including the number of visitors exiting Turkey by country of residence. I will combine datasets covering the periods 2003–2012 and 2012–2025 to construct a unified country-year panel dataset. The analysis will focus on selected major source markets, including Germany, the United Kingdom, France, the Netherlands, Russia, Iran, Azerbaijan, Georgia, Bulgaria, and Greece. These countries are chosen to capture variation in market size, geographic proximity, economic conditions, and geopolitical exposure.

To enrich the dataset, I will incorporate macroeconomic indicators for each source country, including GDP growth, inflation, exchange rates, and optionally GDP per capita, obtained from international databases such as the **World Bank**. In addition to event-based shock indicators, I will incorporate publicly available political risk and uncertainty indices (e.g., World Bank political stability indicators) to capture continuous variations in geopolitical conditions. This should allow for a more robust and data-driven representation of geopolitical risk alongside clearly defined shock events.

The resulting dataset will consist of more than 20 years of observations across approximately 10 countries, forming a structured panel dataset suitable for exploratory data analysis, hypothesis testing, and predictive modeling. The analysis will begin with data cleaning and restructuring, followed by exploratory analysis to identify trends, structural breaks, and cross-country differences. Hypothesis testing will be used to evaluate the statistical significance of shock effects across different source markets. In the final stage, machine learning methods will be applied to model tourism demand and identify the key factors influencing changes in tourist arrivals.